

CURRICULUM VANITAS
Elliott Asa Best

Jackson Hole Classical Academy
Jackson, WY 83001

Website: <https://elliottbest.github.io>
Substack: @elliottabest

Positions

2023– Faculty, Jackson Hole Classical Academy, Jackson, WY
2021–23 Curriculum designer, Generations: Passing on the Faith, Colorado Springs, CO
2020–21 Faculty, Ridgeview Classical Schools, Fort Collins, CO
2017–19 Graduate teaching assistant, University of California, Riverside
2017–18 Adjunct professor, California Baptist University

Education

2024 MA christian studies, Dallas Theological Seminary, high honors
2019 MS mathematics, University of California, Riverside
2016 BS mathematics, California Baptist University, cum laude

Awards

2018 Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, UCR
2016 Outstanding Senior in Mathematics Award, CBU

Books and other publications

Swanson, Kevin and EAB. *Math 3: God's Order in Numbers*. Edited by Kevin Swanson. Parker, CO: Generations, 2025. A third-grade math text and workbook.

EAB. *Math 2: God's Wisdom in Numbers*. Edited by Kevin Swanson. Parker, CO: Generations, 2024. A second-grade math text and workbook.

EAB. *Math 1: God's Gift of Numbers*. Edited by Kevin Swanson. Parker, CO: Generations, 2022. A first-grade math text and workbook.

EAB. *Physical Properties Measurement System Dilatometer Option User's Manual*. Quantum Design, Inc. 2016. The technical user's manual for a sub-5°K thermal expansion measurement device.

Current and recent teaching

- Proofs and modern mathematics: a rigorous introduction to the philosophy of mathematics, method of proof, mathematical logic, sets, relations, categories, and finite groups and fields. Primary text: Bloch, *Proofs and Fundamentals*, Springer UTM.
- Calculus: A standard first-year calculus course on limits, derivatives, integrals, differential equations, series, and parametric representations.
- Geometry: A standard high school course on Euclidean geometry, axiomatic systems, mathematical proof, coordinate geometry, and trigonometric functions.

Advising

I taught and wrote letters for the following high school students who went on to study as undergraduates at the following universities.

Oscar Andersen	Princeton University
Bill Robinson	Wheaton University

Courses taught

2025–26	Proofs and modern mathematics Geometry Strings orchestra, violin Greenhouse horticulture
2024–25	Proofs and modern mathematics Calculus Geometry Intermediate Spanish
2023–24	Calculus Geometry Algebra I Intermediate Spanish
2022	Geometry, private instruction
2020–21	Pre-algebra
2018	Integral and series calculus College algebra
2017	Integral and series calculus

Conference and seminar presentations

“Euler’s Bridge Problem and Reflections on Mathematical Curiosity.” Jackson Hole Classical Academy Professional Development, March 2025.

“Topology and the Trinity.” Association of Christians in the Mathematical Sciences Biannual Conference, June 2022.

“The Fundamental Group, a Knot Invariant,” University of California Riverside Low-dimensional Topology Seminar, October 2018.

“A Sculpture of the Siefert Surface of the Trefoil Knot” Joint Mathematics Meetings Art Exhibition, January 2018.

“Khovanov Homology, a Knot Invariant,” California Baptist University Undergraduate Research Exhibition, March 2017.

“Historic Motivations in Mathematics and the Natural Sciences,” California Baptist University Division of Natural and Mathematical Sciences Faculty Seminar, February 2017.

“Development of a Thin-film Photovoltaic Device Effective Area Measurement System.” Colorado State University Photovoltaic Manufacturing and Characterization Labs, November 2014.

“Quantum Efficiency Measurement System Stability.” Colorado State University Celebrating Undergraduate Research & Creativity Poster Session, April 2014.

Languages

- Spanish, reading
- Koine Greek, reading

Community service

- Sunday school teacher at First Baptist Jackson, Wyoming, 2024-2026.
- Camper Companion at Joni and Friends Families with Disabilities Retreat Fresno, California, 2015, 2019.
- Tutoring for children with disabilities and from disadvantaged homes, 2015-2017.
- Intern at Rancho Ebenezer Orphanage with World Gospel Outreach, Honduras, 2015.

Research interests

- Radical orthodoxy, postmodernity, Augustinian and Thomistic metaphysics, Jungian psychology, post-secular philosophy, relational ontology, and category theory
- Theology and philosophy of mathematics, the Pythagorean school, Quadrivium studies, structuralism
- Georg Cantor, Bernard Bolzano, infinity, self-reference, and mathematical paradox
- Finite group theory and group generation

Varias

- My wife, Molly, studied orthopedic surgery and worked as an assistant professor of anatomy at Loma Linda University Medical School. Now, her life is devoted to our two precious little girls. Our eldest will start kindergarten this summer at home. Molly loves living in the shadow of the Tetons, learning languages, listening to audio books, and traveling to the British Isles.
- I am a content outcast and a humble contrarian. I find a kindred spirit in Friedrich Nietzsche and Rick Rubin. Rock climbing is my sport. Being a good dad is my ambition. Music is my food. Theosis is my way.